

Filtering Logs and User Data Lab

Summary: This activity focused on extracting information from server logs and user data files using basic search and filtering tools. I was tasked with navigating through key directories, identifying files with specific naming patterns, and pulling targeted details from user reports. The work emphasized using command-line search techniques to quickly locate relevant information within a larger set of files.

Commands Used:



```
grep  
piping command (|)
```

Overview: I began by moving into the logs directory and using `grep` to filter the server log so that only entries containing the word “error” were displayed. After reviewing the log output, I navigated to the users directory and used the piping command to combine two commands, running `ls | grep` to return only the filenames that matched the specified pattern. This made it easy to narrow down the list of reports without manually scanning through each file. I then searched through the user files by using `grep` directly on their contents, which allowed me to check for specific usernames and identify users associated with particular departments. These steps demonstrated how pattern matching and command chaining can quickly surface the exact information needed from a larger set of files.

Reflection: Working through this activity strengthened my ability to pull specific information from logs and user files using pattern-matching tools. Using `grep` in different ways made it clear how flexible the command can be when filtering both filenames and file contents. Overall, the exercise reinforced how efficient the command line can be for locating targeted details in a larger directory structure.